



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

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— Tantravārttika, Chapter 2, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The Tantravārttika, in its profound exploration of dharma, here directs our attention to a verse from Manu, specifically concerning conduct during times of adversity. Manu instructs that any residual negativity or “papa” accumulated during these difficult times will be cleansed in the end, suggesting that even in challenging circumstances, purification is possible. Further, it advises you to uplift yourself from a state of distress, using whatever means available, whether gentle or forceful, and to then strive to act in accordance with dharma, if you are capable. The passage emphasizes that dharma, in this context, first manifests as atonement or expiation – “prāyashchitta”. Only after purification through this process can you truly benefit from pursuing other goals or fruits of action.

This wisdom offers a powerful message for your everyday existence. When you find yourself entangled in difficult situations, perhaps brought on by misfortune, poor choices, or external forces, remember that the path forward begins with acknowledging any negativity you've accumulated. This isn't about dwelling on guilt, but about recognizing patterns and taking responsibility. The advice to use whatever means necessary to uplift yourself is not a license for recklessness, but a call to resourcefulness. It urges you to tap into your inner strength and to seek support from your community, your spiritual practices, or your own wisdom.

The emphasis on “prāyashchitta” as the first step is crucial. Before seeking external rewards or pursuing grand ambitions, you must first purify your intentions and actions. This could involve making amends, offering apologies, engaging in acts of service, or simply committing to a more mindful way of being. By cleansing your inner landscape, you create the space for genuine growth and lasting fulfillment. The Tantravārttika reminds you that true dharma is not just about following rules, but about cultivating inner purity and aligning your actions with your highest values, even amidst the storms of life.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

How can you apply the principle of “prāyashchitta” in your own life today, to purify your intentions and create space for more authentic action?